

Personal Statement

My name is Piter Garcia and I am an exchange student from the Dominican Republic. In the flowchart of my life I have already achieved a fifty percent of what I have proposed myself to achieve, not only in my career field but also in life. My main goal since high school was to gain a scholarship that allows me to explore different cultures and ways of thinking, especially in the engineering field. Once achieved, I focused in pursuing a double degree to be able to experience and acquire knowledge from two of the most important areas in the engineering field such as computer and electrical. The ambition of having an internship in a company where I could improve and apply all the skills and cognition obtained at Farmingdale State College (FSC) became my main target until I achieved it. This company is Data Device Corporation (DDC); this is where I have been introduced to numerous projects in my field that make me feel part of building innovative technology. This Innovation improves our way of living by changing people's life styles. It is through my studies at FSC and work at DDC that I have come across the following decisions that will determine the path of my future.

First, my perspective as an engineer changed ever since I was introduced to computer programming at FSC. Then, I realized that programming was not only something I could easily figure out, but something I enjoy and love doing. For once in my life, I felt I found something that I was able to identify myself with. This something is computer science, and I know that in a prestigious institution like CULUMBIA University I will be able to experience this kind of feeling and more. I want to keep experiencing this hunger of knowledge; feeling of wanting to know more about a field through which I can find myself and still be part of building innovative technology. I feel that with my background in electrical & computer engineering technology and the support of a well-known and respected institution as CULUMBIA University I can achieve my goals beyond my expectations.

Second, my most desired goal is the acceptance at CULUMBIA University to request my country to provide me with another scholarship at this institution. An institution where I will be able to specialize myself in the area I like the most, computer engineering. This will prepare me and channel my future goals as an engineer by opening new doors on my path; doors through which I will be able to get an enduring job as a computer engineer. A lasting job is one of the most ambitious goals I have been trying to accomplish ever since the beginning of my senior year at FSC. The reason why is because this would be the root where a new chapter of my life as an engineer will be born, a chapter where I build my own company to create new technology. I will contribute to my country's development as well as the whole planet with innovations to improve our living condition on this planet.

Finally, I will be graduating from FSC with an average above 3.1. I know this is not one of the best averages for a high-status institution like CULUMBIA University. However, I put in perspective the fact that in less than five years I pursued a double degree while working part time to help my family with their economic issues. It has been difficult to keep both a dual degree and a job, but I have managed myself to maintain a balance between my studies and work with my job and dedication. It is with the same effort and dedication that I want to start my master studies at CULUMBIA University to lead my future on a path that can lead others.

Sincerely,

Piter Garcia
Computer & Electrical Engineer
March 20th, 2012